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Alan Kydd

Senior Software Engineer

Backend Engineer specializing in Go, APIs, and cloud-based SaaS platforms.

Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 18 years of experience designing and building backend systems and scalable web applications in startups and large organizations. Specialized in Go, APIs, and cloud-based infrastructure, with strong experience building scalable services and internal tools that improve operational efficiency. Recent work includes leading backend development for major features in a SaaS platform, integrating Google Workspace and AWS infrastructure, and developing internal systems enabling non-engineers to manage complex workflows.

Key Skills

Languages: Go, TypeScript, Clojure, SQL

Backend: Go, GraphQL, REST APIs, microservices, Clojure

Frontend: React, Redux, TypeScript, ClojureScript

Tools: Claude Code, Git

Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Apache Kafka

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Cassandra

Other: Stripe, Adyen, Google Workspace

Experience

Senior Fullstack Engineer, *Looka*, Toronto, Ontario.

10/2022–09/2025

Laid off due to company-wide reduction in force.

- Led backend architecture and implementation (Go, GraphQL) for two major customer-facing features in Looka's flagship SaaS platform:
 - Google Workspace Reseller integration allowing customers to purchase and manage subscriptions directly within Looka.
 - AWS-based website hosting platform enabling users to deploy branded websites created in Looka.
- Implemented a drop-shadow feature for Looka's SVG-based graphic editor.
- Developed TypeScript automation tools for the Customer Service team, reducing engineering involvement in support cases and improving ticket resolution speed.

Senior Software Engineer, *Betable*, Edmonton, Alberta.

09/2021–10/2022

- Designed and delivered a React/Redux application with supporting backend REST endpoints (Go) for managing third-party online casino games.
- Replaced a manual engineering workflow with an internal tool that enabled non-engineers to manage game deployments independently.
- Contributed to an Adyen payment integration, implementing a Go microservice backend with Angular and React frontends.

Software Engineer , <i>Betable</i> , Edmonton, Alberta.	01/2016–09/2021
○ Developed internal marketing tools enabling non-technical teams to create, edit, and schedule promotions, bonuses, and game offers. ○ Implemented backend services and features (including Go-based components) alongside React/Redux front-end development.	
Developer , <i>Gamesys Canada</i> , Edmonton, Alberta.	08/2013–10/2015
Laid off due to company restructuring.	
○ Built a Backbone.js single-page application for managing online poker tournaments, communicating with an event-driven microservice backend using Apache Kafka. ○ Contributed to a GWT analytics application used to investigate poker game fraud and analyze player win/loss data.	
Developer , <i>CGI Canada</i> , Edmonton, Alberta.	10/2011–08/2013
Developed enhancements for two public-sector Java EE web applications.	
IT Specialist , <i>IBM Canada</i> , Edmonton, Alberta.	03/2007–09/2011
Delivered 30+ enhancements and production fixes for public-sector Java EE systems. including eHealth Saskatchewan's Pharmaceutical Information Program.	
Junior Developer , <i>ShirWin Knowledge and Learning Inc.</i> , Edmonton, Alberta.	01/2007–03/2007
Implemented a real-time chat system and UI components for a systematic review web application.	

Education

Masters of Science , <i>University of Alberta</i> , Edmonton.	2005
Pure Mathematics	
Bachelor of Science , <i>University of Alberta</i> , Edmonton.	2002
Mathematics Specialization	

Selected Projects

RealWorld Go API : https://github.com/akydd/realworld-backend-go . Implementation of the RealWorld backend API specification in Go, developed using an AI-assisted workflow (Claude Code).
RealWorld Clojure API : https://github.com/akydd/realworld-clojure . Implementation of the RealWorld backend API specification in Clojure, demonstrating REST API architecture, authentication, and production-style backend patterns.
MOS 6502 Emulator : https://github.com/akydd/nes_emulator . Implemented a MOS 6502 CPU emulator in C supporting the full 8-bit instruction set.